columns have been increased from IV to XFD – 256 to 16384 columns. Again, you must use the XLSX format to be able to access this functionality. If you have older XLS files, open them and save them as XLSX files and they will get the new functionality, and also save on disk space, as the XLSX format uses compression as well.

Studies have shown that professionals spend about ten per cent of our working lives focussed on a spreadsheet. This number skyrockets for those who work in finance or research. Heck, even we writers spend way too much time in a spreadsheet, trying to organise our work and fill in various deadline trackers, and if it's a review we're doing then our test scores are calculated by a spreadsheet with loads of formulae. Bottom line, you can't afford to not be an Excel wizard in this day and age.

Lookup functions

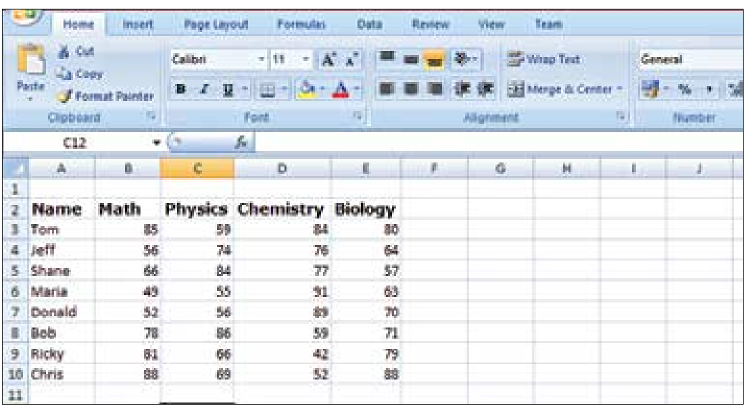
The following functions are most useful when analysing large amounts of data in a spreadsheet:

1. Vlookup()

This is one way to search for any value in the table. You can use this function to not only search for a value, but you can also use it to list a matching value from a different column in the same row! Here is the syntax:

```
VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])
```

Here, `lookup_value` is a target value to search from the table. It may be a number, text, or date. `table-array` is two or more columns. On the



Name	Math	Physics	Chemistry	Biology
Tom	85	59	84	80
Jeff	56	74	76	64
Shane	66	84	77	57
Maria	49	55	91	63
Donald	52	56	89	70
Bob	78	86	59	71
Ricky	81	66	42	79
Chris	88	69	52	88